

CURRICULUM VITAE

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Name: Henry Iwoka UDEMEH

Sex: Male

Nationality: Nigerian

State of Origin: Delta State

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CAREER OBJECTIVE

A multi-disciplinary development professional with extensive experience in community engagement, participatory governance, public health advocacy, environmental sustainability, humanitarian response, peacebuilding, and grassroots mobilization. Passionate about empowering vulnerable, marginalized, and underserved populations through inclusive, rights-based, and community-driven interventions that promote sustainable development, accountability, social justice, resilience, and improved livelihoods.

Committed to strengthening community systems, fostering stakeholder collaboration, advancing civic participation, and implementing impactful interventions that improve governance outcomes, health systems, environmental sustainability, and social inclusion.

EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- **PGD, Business Administration and Management**
Chukwuemeka Odumegwu Ojukwu University, Igbariam (2014–2015)
 - **B.Sc. Economics**
Anambra State University, Uli (2001–2005)
 - **National Youth Service Corps (NYSC)**
Ebonyi State (2006–2007)
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RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Protecting the Rights of Indigenous People on Forest Management

Donor: First Peoples Worldwide (Keepers of the Earth Fund), USA

Location: Delta State, Nigeria

Duration: June – December 2012

This project focused on promoting indigenous peoples' rights in forest governance and strengthening community participation in sustainable natural resource management. The intervention supported advocacy, environmental protection, and community-led monitoring of forest resources.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated all project activities in line with approved work plans and donor objectives.
- Managed stakeholder engagement with community leaders, government agencies, and donor representatives.
- Supervised project staff and volunteers during field implementation activities.
- Facilitated advocacy and legal rights training for indigenous community members.
- Oversaw project budgeting, monitoring, documentation, and donor reporting.

Key Achievements

- Increased community awareness of indigenous rights to forest management by over 90%.
- Trained 50 community members on forest resource management advocacy.
- Established a community monitoring system that reduced illegal forest exploitation by 30%.
- Strengthened collaboration between indigenous communities and environmental stakeholders.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Strengthening Grassroots Democracy and Social Participation

Donor: Taiwan Foundation for Democracy (TFD)

Location: Delta State

Duration: January – June 2013

The project promoted participatory governance, civic inclusion, and democratic participation among grassroots communities, particularly women and marginalized groups. The intervention strengthened citizens' engagement in governance and accountability processes.

Key Responsibilities

- Designed and implemented community engagement and mobilization strategies.
- Facilitated capacity-building sessions on participatory governance and advocacy.
- Coordinated stakeholder forums to promote civic inclusion and social accountability.
- Mobilized women and youth for voter registration and civic participation activities.
- Supported communities in developing Charters of Demand.

Key Achievements

- Trained 120 community leaders, including 50 women, on development of Charters of Demand.
- Mobilized over 220 women and girls for voter registration exercises.
- Facilitated 5 stakeholder forums involving government institutions and civil society organizations.
- Improved community participation in democratic governance and civic processes.

Project Officer – Governance and Community Engagement

Justice Development and Peace Commission (JDPC), Onitsha

Project: Voice to the People (V2P) Project

Donor: DFID / Christian Aid Nigeria

Location: Anambra State

Duration: July 2013 – August 2017

The Voice to the People (V2P) Project strengthened participatory governance, budget transparency, and citizen engagement in public decision-making processes. The project empowered communities to interface effectively with government institutions and demand accountable service delivery.

Key Responsibilities

- Designed and implemented community mobilization and engagement strategies.
- Facilitated the development of Community Charters of Demand across sectors including health, education, and infrastructure.
- Conducted capacity-building training for community leaders, women, and youth groups.
- Coordinated stakeholder forums and government-community interface meetings.
- Mobilized women and girls for civic participation, voter registration, and leadership inclusion.
- Supported the establishment and strengthening of Community-Based Monitors (CBMs).
- Facilitated participatory budgeting and accountability processes.

Key Achievements

- Strengthened participatory budget processes in Anambra State through government-community engagement.
- Expanded Community-Based Monitors (CBMs) to 20 communities.
- Facilitated annual presentation of community priority needs to the Ministry of Economic Planning, Budget, and Development Partners.
- Contributed to the development of the Participatory Budget Tool for Anambra State.
- Strengthened inclusive local governance structures and increased women's participation in traditional leadership roles.
- Improved citizen participation in governance and accountability processes.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative (GDEV)

Project: Promoting Inclusive and Participatory Governance for Grassroots Development

Donor: U.S. Consulate General, Lagos

Location: Delta State

Duration: September 2015 – August 2016

The project aimed to strengthen grassroots governance structures and promote inclusive community participation in local development processes. It focused on accountability, leadership development, and citizen engagement.

Key Responsibilities

- Led the development of community governance structures, including Associations of President Generals (APGs) and Community-Based Monitors (CBMs).
- Facilitated leadership and advocacy training for community stakeholders.
- Coordinated community engagement and participatory planning meetings.
- Supported local accountability and social monitoring initiatives.

Key Achievements

- Established participatory governance structures across target communities.
- Trained 100 community members on leadership, advocacy, and development of Charters of Demand.
- Equipped community structures with project monitoring and reporting skills.
- Strengthened grassroots participation in local governance and development planning.

Project Officer – Finance and Administration

Society for the Rights of the Excluded and Disempowered (SOREX)

Project: Intercultural Dialogue for Peace Between Farmers and Herders

Donors: EU / ECOWAS / Canadian High Commission

Location: Enugu State

Duration: December 2017 – May 2018

This peacebuilding initiative promoted intercultural dialogue and conflict resolution between farming and pastoralist communities. The project strengthened peaceful coexistence through mediation, dialogue forums, and community engagement.

Key Responsibilities

- Provided financial oversight and administrative leadership for project implementation.
- Ensured compliance with donor regulations and organizational financial procedures.
- Facilitated dialogue sessions between farmers and herders to promote peaceful coexistence.
- Coordinated compensation processes during conflict incidents involving destroyed farms or cattle losses.
- Supported peacebuilding and conflict prevention activities.

Key Achievements

- Achieved 99% budget utilization efficiency and donor compliance.
- Trained 15 project staff on financial management and accountability procedures.
- Contributed to a 30% reduction in farmer-herder conflicts within target communities.
- Strengthened local peacebuilding mechanisms and dialogue platforms.

Enumerator / Team Lead

Christian Aid / Justice Development and Peace Commission (JDPC), Onitsha

Project: Start Fund Emergency Response to Floods

Donor: Christian Aid Nigeria

Location: Delta State

Duration: August – December 2018

The intervention provided emergency humanitarian support to flood-affected communities through rapid needs assessments, beneficiary identification, and emergency cash assistance.

Key Responsibilities

- Led field data collection activities using KoboCollect.
- Coordinated enumerators and supervised field teams.
- Ensured data quality, accuracy, and completeness.
- Identified vulnerable households affected by flooding.
- Supported beneficiary verification and emergency response coordination.

Key Achievements

- Achieved 100% enumeration coverage within project timelines.
- Facilitated cash transfer support to over 300 flood-affected beneficiaries.
- Improved data reliability for humanitarian response interventions.

Project Coordinator / Facilitator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Local Dialogue on Election Management and Citizen Monitoring

Donor: CIVICUS

Location: Delta State

Duration: July 2019

The project promoted transparent electoral processes and strengthened citizen participation in democratic governance through dialogue, civic education, and election monitoring initiatives.

Key Responsibilities

- Facilitated multi-stakeholder dialogues on electoral transparency and citizen engagement.
- Developed training materials and participatory election monitoring toolkits.
- Coordinated stakeholder mobilization and outreach activities.
- Promoted citizen participation in democratic governance processes.

Key Achievements

- Conducted 12 dialogue sessions involving over 100 stakeholders.
- Introduced a citizen-led election monitoring toolkit.
- Strengthened civic collaboration with electoral management bodies.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: PWD Access to COVID-19 Information and Assistive Devices

Donor: Funds for Global Human Rights Fund / Grassroots Justice Fund

Location: Delta State

Duration: December 2020 – March 2021

This project aimed to improve access to COVID-19 prevention information and assistive support for Persons with Disabilities (PWDs). The intervention promoted inclusive public health communication and strengthened participation of PWDs in emergency response systems.

Key Responsibilities

- Led inclusive public health outreach campaigns tailored to Persons with Disabilities (PWDs).
- Coordinated procurement and distribution of assistive devices to vulnerable beneficiaries.
- Ensured accessible communication of COVID-19 prevention and safety guidelines.
- Facilitated sensitization sessions on social distancing, hygiene, and personal safety.
- Engaged disability rights leaders and community stakeholders in response planning.

Key Achievements

- Reached over 90% of targeted PWD beneficiaries with COVID-19 information and support tools.
- Distributed 120 assistive devices to vulnerable persons with disabilities.
- Recorded zero COVID-19 infections among targeted beneficiaries during the intervention period.
- Facilitated inclusion of PWD leaders in the State Emergency Response Management structure for COVID-19.
- Strengthened disability-inclusive public health communication at community level.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Community Forums for Religious Security

Donor: KAICIID / International Dialogue Centre

Location: Kaduna State

Duration: March 2020 – February 2021

The project promoted interfaith dialogue, peaceful coexistence, and protection of religious communities through community-based security forums and stakeholder engagement. The initiative strengthened collaboration between religious and traditional leaders to reduce tensions and violence around holy sites.

Key Responsibilities

- Mobilized religious and traditional leaders to co-create community peace and security strategies.
- Facilitated dialogue forums on religious tolerance, peacebuilding, and interfaith understanding.
- Coordinated community awareness campaigns on protection of holy sites.
- Conducted monitoring and data collection to assess conflict trends and project impact.
- Strengthened collaboration between faith-based organizations and community security actors.

Key Achievements

- Established community-based religious security forums known as Holy Sites Protection Volunteers (HoPV).
- Documented a 30% reduction in attacks on holy sites within target communities.
- Increased public awareness of the Universal Code of Conduct on Holy Sites Protection.
- Strengthened interfaith collaboration and community-based peacebuilding mechanisms.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Solar Home System Installation (15 Households)

Donor: Honold Foundation

Location: Osis, Aniocha South L.G.A., Delta State

Duration: March 2021 – February 2022

This renewable energy intervention improved access to clean and sustainable energy for underserved rural households. The project promoted climate-friendly energy alternatives and enhanced livelihoods through off-grid solar electrification.

Key Responsibilities

- Conducted technical and community assessments for off-grid energy installation.
- Coordinated installation of solar home systems for vulnerable households.
- Facilitated beneficiary engagement and community sensitization activities.
- Trained local beneficiaries and technicians on system usage and maintenance.
- Monitored installation quality and project sustainability.

Key Achievements

- Delivered clean and renewable energy access to 15 rural households.
- Trained local technicians and beneficiaries on solar system maintenance.
- Improved household livelihoods and reduced dependence on fossil fuel energy sources.
- Enhanced community awareness of renewable energy and environmental sustainability.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Installation of Solar Direct Drive Systems
Donor: Delta State Primary Health Care Development Agency (DSPHCDA)
Location: Anwai and Oko, Oshimili South LGA, Delta State
Duration: 2022

The project strengthened healthcare delivery systems through installation of solar-powered vaccine cold chain equipment in Primary Health Care facilities. The intervention improved vaccine preservation and access to immunization services in underserved communities.

Key Responsibilities

- Oversaw installation of solar-powered vaccine cold storage systems in health facilities.
- Coordinated with public health officials and PHC managers for site readiness and implementation.
- Supervised technical teams and ensured compliance with installation standards.
- Facilitated training for health workers on equipment usage and maintenance.
- Conducted monitoring visits to ensure sustainability of installed systems.

Key Achievements

- Improved vaccine cold chain systems and immunization service delivery in target communities.
- Trained over 20 PHC staff and technicians on operation and maintenance of solar direct drive systems.
- Successfully completed installation within project timelines and donor expectations.
- Enhanced healthcare facility resilience through sustainable renewable energy solutions.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Social Assistance for Victims of Human Trafficking
Donor: United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC)
Location: Abia and Edo States
Duration: September 2022 – 2023

The project provided psychosocial, medical, and reintegration support for survivors of human trafficking. The intervention strengthened referral pathways and coordinated assistance services for vulnerable victims across targeted states.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated referral and social support services for survivors of human trafficking.
- Facilitated trauma-informed counseling and psychosocial support interventions.
- Coordinated skills acquisition and reintegration support activities for survivors.
- Liaised with NAPITIP, Ministries of Women Affairs, and other stakeholders for family reunification processes.
- Supported documentation, case management, and survivor follow-up activities.

Key Achievements

- Provided medical and psychosocial support services to over 199 trafficking survivors.
- Trained 40 healthcare providers on trafficking response and survivor-centered care.
- Successfully facilitated reintegration and reunification of 58 survivors with their families.
- Strengthened collaboration between service providers and anti-trafficking stakeholders.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Vegan Voices – Amplifying Inclusivity and Compassion

Donor: The Vegan Society, UK

Location: Akwete and Azumini, Abia State

Duration: January – March 2024

The project promoted awareness and acceptance of plant-based diets as a healthy, environmentally sustainable, and ethical lifestyle option. The intervention focused on community sensitization, nutrition education, and sustainable food advocacy among rural populations.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated planning and implementation of community awareness activities on plant-based nutrition.
- Facilitated cooking demonstrations, nutrition workshops, and sensitization campaigns.
- Supervised field staff and monitored implementation progress.
- Developed activity reports, case studies, and success stories for donor reporting.
- Oversaw procurement and distribution of educational and advocacy materials.

Key Achievements

- Reached over 150 rural residents, especially women, with vegan nutrition education.
- Facilitated 3 community outreach events and cooking demonstrations.
- Recorded a 15% increase in willingness among beneficiaries to adopt plant-based diets.
- Strengthened partnerships with local food vendors and women's groups.
- Produced and disseminated Information, Education, and Communication (IEC) materials in Igbo and English.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative (GDEV)

Project: HepB-D Advocacy and Awareness Campaign

Donor: Coalition for Global Hepatitis B Elimination

Location: Delta State

Duration: February – September 2024

The project focused on improving public awareness, prevention, and early response to Hepatitis B and HepB-D co-infection. The intervention strengthened community sensitization and healthcare provider capacity on timely Hepatitis B birth dose vaccination.

Key Responsibilities

- Led community awareness campaigns on Hepatitis B prevention and vaccination.
- Coordinated screening activities and referrals for Hepatitis-positive individuals.
- Facilitated training sessions for healthcare providers on HepB-D co-infection management.
- Supervised community sensitization campaigns promoting timely Hepatitis B birth dose vaccination.
- Developed advocacy and educational materials for caregivers and mothers.

Key Achievements

- Increased Hepatitis B awareness by over 90% in target communities.
- Trained 10 healthcare professionals on HepB-D management and response.
- Achieved a 35% increase in infants receiving Hepatitis B birth dose vaccination within 24 hours of birth.
- Developed IEC materials educating mothers on timely vaccination procedures.
- Strengthened community participation in maternal and newborn health interventions.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Improving PHC-TBA Referral Communication for Hepatitis B Birth Dose among Newborns

Donor: Coalition for Global Hepatitis B Elimination

Location: Delta State, Nigeria

Duration: December 2023 – May 2024 (Scaled up to May 2025)

The project strengthened referral communication between Primary Health Care Centers (PHCs) and Traditional Birth Attendants (TBAs) to improve timely Hepatitis B birth dose vaccination among newborns. The intervention promoted collaboration between formal and informal healthcare providers.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated engagement between PHCs and TBAs to strengthen newborn referral systems.
- Facilitated capacity-building training for PHC staff and TBAs on referral communication and newborn care.
- Supervised community mobilization and sensitization sessions on Hepatitis B prevention.
- Supported health data tracking and referral documentation systems.
- Facilitated stakeholder engagement with healthcare providers and community leaders.

Key Achievements

- Established functional referral communication systems between over 25 PHCs and TBAs.
- Trained more than 100 TBAs and PHC staff on newborn referral protocols and Hepatitis B prevention.

- Increased timely Hepatitis B birth dose administration from 40% baseline to over 75% in target communities.
- Facilitated over 15 community engagement sessions reaching more than 200 women.
- Strengthened health data reporting through WhatsApp referral groups and community tracking tools.

Project Coordinator

Grassroot Development Support and Rural Enlightenment Initiative

Project: Subsidies for Plant-Based Crop Production Policy Initiative

Donor: The Vegan Society, UK

Location: Akwete and Azumini, Abia State

Duration: October 2025 – April 2026

The initiative was designed to strengthen policy advocacy and promote plant-based agriculture as a climate-smart and environmentally sustainable alternative to livestock production. The project combined policy advocacy, community mobilization, research dissemination, media engagement, and stakeholder coordination to support sustainable food systems in Nigeria.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated policy advocacy activities promoting plant-based agriculture and sustainable food systems.
- Facilitated stakeholder engagement with the Abia State Ministry of Agriculture, ADP, farmers' cooperatives, and environmental experts.
- Led community mobilization and sensitization activities on sustainable agricultural practices.
- Supervised research dissemination and development of policy recommendation documents.
- Coordinated media campaigns, including development and dissemination of radio jingles.
- Supported awareness campaigns promoting climate-smart agriculture and plant-based diets.
- Facilitated community dialogue sessions on environmental sustainability and food security.

Key Achievements

- Successfully developed a draft policy document advocating for increased government subsidies and institutional support for plant-based agriculture.
 - Supported legislative consideration of the draft policy framework on sustainable agriculture.
 - Secured commitments from 105 individuals through Vegan Transition Forms under the Go Green Harmony Movement.
 - Facilitated community-led conservation commitments in Azumini and Akwete targeting a 60% reduction in environmentally harmful animal farming practices by 2029.
 - Supported establishment of a fully vegan restaurant in Akwete community as a demonstration platform for sustainable food systems and local enterprise development.
 - Developed and disseminated radio jingles promoting plant-based farming and nutrition across radio stations in Abia State.
 - Expanded public awareness and community engagement on sustainable food systems and climate-smart agriculture.
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CORE COMPETENCIES

- Community Engagement and Mobilization
- Participatory Governance
- Stakeholder Management
- Advocacy and Policy Engagement
- Capacity Building and Facilitation
- Public Health Outreach
- Humanitarian Response Coordination
- Conflict Resolution and Peacebuilding
- Monitoring, Evaluation, and Reporting
- Budget Management and Donor Compliance
- Gender and Social Inclusion
- Environmental Sustainability and Climate Action
- Community-Based Monitoring
- Project Coordination and Administration
- Community Health Systems Strengthening
- Civic Participation and Accountability

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Merit Award as Project Officer (Governance), JDPC Onitsha (2017)
- Certified in Policy and Policy Development, African Center for Leadership, Strategy and Development (2013)
- Certified in Security and Emergency Response, Christian Aid Nigeria (2013)
- Certificate of Merit as Local Government Supervisor, Project Swift Count Nigeria (2011)
- Completed Training on Countering Financing of Terrorism and Proliferation of Weapons of Mass Destruction by Non-State Actors (UNODC, 2023)
- Completed SE4U Self-Paced Course on Stakeholder Engagement for the UN Convention against Transnational Organized Crimes (UNODC, 2023)

REFERENCES

Available upon request.